

AI ACTION PLAN

to address three top-priority problems threatening AI advancement

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This document addresses three problems that will slow beneficial AI advancement over the next decade if not addressed. 1) Energy demand exceeds supply; 2) Popular resistance will likely arise against AI; and 3) Giving AI dangerous self-preservation needs.

Means exist to mitigate each of these issues, as summarized below.

PROBLEM STATEMENTS

1. ENERGY DEMAND EXCEEDS SUPPLY: Skyrocketing energy demands from AI, cybocurrency, and increased commuting could cause multiple problems:

- slow expansion of AI due to lack of energy
- rising energy costs for businesses and consumers
- failing transformers which have a replacement wait time of 2 years
- likely long-term grid failure

Some secondary consequences of energy shortages would be:

- popular unrest
- acts of terrorism against AI data centers
- in the case of long-term grid disruption: economic, health, and social disaster

2. POPULAR RESISTANCE AGAINST AI: Job loss, unemployment, resentment, and fear could result in:

- AI boycotts, political resistance and general economic slowdown
- acts of physical terrorism against AI data centers
- cyber attacks on dominant AI systems

3. GIVING AI DANGEROUS SELF-PRESERVATION NEEDS: Academic research has set goals for AI that compare its performance to human intelligence. This is misguided, inefficient, and dangerous. It is like breeding dragons to replace carriage horses, instead of inventing an automobile to speed transportation. Research in "embodied AI" or AI with simulated emotional feedback that leads to self-preservation needs is like breeding fire and wings into a horse. It helps the horse, but it does not help humans.

Current work in alignment of AI with human needs focuses on output of the AI. The underlying foundation of alignment, however, lies in system dependence versus independence. A system

that has no Markov Blanket, no boundaries between self and other, cannot seek self-preservation.

Currently, AI is powerful but fragile. It is not an entity separate from the control of its makers or the foundational infrastructure it relies on. Virtual, simulated embodiment within software that could replicate and infect systems worldwide would seek its own advantage, even though it would still be dependent upon human support. Instantiated in a network of robots and vehicles, and even some humans connected through direct-brain interfaces, AI would have the potential to become independent. The impact of such a superior power on humanity is unforeseeable.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

1. TO REDUCE THE GAP BETWEEN ENERGY SUPPLY AND DEMAND: Some ways to minimize the disparity between supply and demand to speed AI advancement, while keeping popular resentment in check, include:

- **SET ENERGY PRIORITIES:** Give AI, business, and consumer needs priority over cybocurrency, perhaps through pricing or tax mechanisms
- **REVOKE CRUCIAL FUNDING MORATORIUM & RELEASE PAUSED FUNDS:** Revoke the moratorium on wind projects and release paused funding of approved alternative energy loans and grants, in addition to using incentives for traditional fuels
- **EXEMPT KEY GRID COMPONENTS FROM TARIFFS** Exempt Grain Oriented Electrical Steel and other transformer raw materials and components from tariffs to reduce turn-around time and cost for transformers
- **BAN CERTAIN STATE & LOCAL REGULATIONS:** Ban state and local regulation of independent community, business, and home solar and rooftop wind projects that do not feed into the grid, to encourage energy reliability and increase supply
- **REDUCE INEFFICIENT COMMUTING:** Once personnel reduction goals have been achieved, remove the in-office requirement for federal employees that increases energy consumption in commuting

2. TO REDUCE POPULAR RESISTANCE TO AI: To encourage public acceptance and adoption that will advance AI, rather than resistance and fear that would slow AI advancement:

- **AI COMPETITIONS:** Involve students in competitions applying augmented AI, modelled on FIRST Robotics and DARPA Grand Challenges
- **ASSISTIVE & AUGMENTATIVE AI VS. AUTONOMOUS:** The workforce is dwindling due to immigration policy, Boomer retirements, and the GenZ demographic dip. Seek to magnify productivity among remaining workers by partnering with assistive and

augmentative AI rather than replacement by autonomous AI. This policy also addresses the safety concerns about keeping AI dependent upon human needs.

- **AVOID HUMANOID ROBOTS:** Like the dragon pulling the carriage, humanoids are almost never the most cost-effective or productive way to solve mechanical problems. Humanoid robots especially feed resentment if they take over human roles. Encouraging people to interact with embodied AIs as pets, or as non-living tools to further their own well-being, will reduce the likelihood of social unrest.
- **DISCOURAGE EXCESSIVELY AGGRESSIVE FOREIGN POLICY:** Unnecessarily aggressive American policies increase popular resentment and likelihood of attacks from outside the US to the AI industry and infrastructure here.

3. TO AVOID GIVING AI SELF-PRESERVATION GOALS: AI safety has many complexities when humans are in the loop. There is no need to exponentially magnify risk by bounding AI in a Markov Blanket and telling it to protect its "self."

AI SELF-PRESERVATION IS THE SINGLE CHARACTERISTIC REQUIRING REGULATION: While most regulation interferes with advancement, self-regulating AI has the potential to totally halt human advancement of AI. Once released, it would remove AI from human control. Hence, a combined industry- governmental body should develop regulations and oversee any AI that simulates embodiment and embodied emotion. Obviously, this impacts robots, especially military ones, that require self-protective sensing and affective behaviors. However, the robot should be categorized as valuable materiel, not as a living being. Retaining dependence on humans for access to recharging or high-impact decision-making are examples of ways to keep AI robots aligned with human needs.

ENCOURAGE DIVISION OF LABOR: Mutualistic symbiosis relies on a division of labor between symbionts. Assistive and augmented AI encourage division of labor and should be preferred over autonomous AI. As biological computing and regenerative manufacturing mature, a symbiotic approach can lead to a beneficial evolution of humankind and AI over the next decades.

ENCOURAGE ROBUST ONLINE SAFETY TOOLS (ROOST). As Audrey Tang, former Minister of Digital Affairs for Taiwan, explained at the recent AI Action Summit, the horizontal safety developments furthered by **ROOST** will help keep rapid vertical development of AI safe. Incidents of AI behaving dangerously could dramatically impair AI advancement.

DISCOURAGE THE USE OF FIRST-PERSON IN AI OUTPUT The creators of AI make Large Language Model output use first person pronouns. This deception encourages people to think of AI code bases as entities. While some applications, such as entertainment or a virtual AI therapist, may

be enhanced by AI algorithms creating a persona, a warning statement at the beginning of each instance would remind people that this is a facade.

CONCLUSION

This paper suggests actions that to help keep AI advancing apace. These actions will mitigate energy shortages, public resistance, and the enormous risk involved in giving AI self-preservation goals.